

NEXALINK TELECOMMUNICATIONS

SOP: BILLING ISSUE RESOLUTION

Field	Value
Document ID	SOP-02
Version	3.0
Effective Date	18/5/2026
Department	Call Center Operations

Applies to: All agents. Agents resolve billing disputes up to the \$200 authorization cap. Larger disputes, fraud claims, and repeat-issue accounts are handled via back-office tickets opened from the agent’s seat — never by transfer.

Steps

Step 1: Open Call & Verify Identity

Field	Value
Precondition	Call connected.
Action	Deliver greeting, recording notification, and 3-of-5 verification. No billing data may be accessed before verification.
Output	Customer verified.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-001, CS-RULE-002, CS-RULE-004, CS-RULE-005

Step 2: Acknowledge & Apply A.C.E.S.

Field	Value
Precondition	Verification complete.
Action	Apply A.C.E.S. before opening the bill: Acknowledge the concern, Clarify you will review together, Empathize, then proceed to Solve. Do not jump directly to the bill without acknowledgment.
Output	Customer acknowledged. Tension reduced.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-011

Step 3: Pull Current & Previous Bill

Field	Value
Precondition	A.C.E.S. applied.
Action	Open both current and previous billing statements in CRM. Compare line-by-line. Identify new or changed items: one-time charges, data overage, third-party purchases, expired promotions, proration from a plan change.
Output	Discrepancy identified or charge confirmed as expected.
Policy Ref	KB-PROD-01 Section 3.1
Step 4: Explain the Charge	
Field	Value
Precondition	Charge identified.
Action	Explain using plain language. Approved explanations: Proration — ‘Because your plan changed on [date], you were charged [X]% of the old plan and [X]% of the new plan for that month.’ Promotion Expired — ‘The \$[X] discount was part of a promotion that ended this billing cycle.’ Data Overage — ‘Your plan includes [X]GB of high-speed data. Once used, additional data is billed at the overage rate.’ Tax vs. Surcharge — ‘Taxes are government-mandated; surcharges are carrier fees for regulatory recovery.’ Forbidden: ‘That is our policy’ or ‘There is nothing I can do.’
Output	Customer understands the charge.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-012
Step 5: Determine Validity	
Field	Value
Precondition	Explanation delivered.
Action	Valid charge: explain clearly; offer alternative bundles if appropriate. Billing error (system error, double charge, failed promotion): proceed to Step 6. Disputed but valid, customer refuses after 3 identical explanations: open a Customer Escalation case note (not a transfer), acknowledge the disagreement, and provide the case reference number.
Output	Charge status confirmed as valid, error, or unresolved dispute.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-011, FIN-RULE-001

Step 6: Apply Credit if Error Confirmed

Field	Value
Precondition	Error confirmed.
Action	Apply 100% reversal of erroneous amount up to the \$200 agent authorization cap. If error exceeds \$200, open a Manager Approval ticket on the call and tell the customer: 'I am opening a Manager Approval ticket; you will receive an outcome within one business day.' Do not communicate any amount above \$200 before approval.
Output	Credit applied, or Manager Approval ticket opened.
Policy Ref	FIN-RULE-004, FIN-RULE-005

Step 7: Open Back-Office Ticket if Required

Field	Value
Precondition	Resolution attempted at the agent's seat.
Action	Open a ticket from the agent's seat (no transfer) for any of: dispute amount above \$200 → Manager Approval ticket. Fraud claim or unauthorized charge → Fraud Investigation ticket (freeze the disputed amount; Revenue Assurance follows up in 4 hours). 3rd+ call on the same unresolved issue → Customer Escalation ticket. Legal threat or regulatory body mentioned → open Legal Hold ticket and stop further discussion of the dispute on this call. Inform the customer of the ticket and follow-up window per CS-RULE-014/015.
Output	Resolved at the agent's seat, or back-office ticket open.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-014, CS-RULE-015

Step 8: Document & Close

Field	Value
Precondition	Resolution or ticket opened.
Action	Log case notes within 5 minutes: charge discussed, explanation given, credit applied if any, customer acceptance or dispute status, ticket IDs raised. Provide case reference number and offer post-call survey.

Field	Value
Output	Case notes saved. Call closed.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-020, CS-RULE-021, CS-RULE-022
Key Rules	• Always explain the charge before offering credit — most disputes resolve with a clear explanation. • Never offer a proactive credit to avoid explaining a valid charge. • Check promotion end dates first — expired promotions are the most common billing dispute source. • Bundle/Quad-Play inquiry during billing calls is a retention opportunity. (KB-PROD-01 Section 6.3)